

THE MOTION

This House Believes that

India should move from a culture of familial obligation towards one of individual autonomy

MARK WHERE YOU STAND, NOW AND ON THE WAY OUT THE FAMILY DECIDES ☐ ☐ ☐ ☒ ☐ ☐ ☐ YOU DECIDE

WHAT THE WORDS MEAN

FAMILIAL OBLIGATION

The social, cultural and moral expectation that you put your family's needs and expectations first in an important decision. Care of parents, money, marriage, career, the family's name.

INDIVIDUAL AUTONOMY

The freedom to make those same decisions by your own values and aspirations, without undue outside pressure. Career, partner, where you live, what you believe, what you do with your money.

MOVE TOWARDS

A shift in the balance, not a replacement. Nobody is proposing that family stops mattering. The motion asks which way the weight should sit.

THE REAL DISAGREEMENT

BOTH SIDES AGREE

Family matters, and so does the freedom to choose your own life. Neither side is arguing to abolish either, and both accept that every culture strikes some balance between them.

THEY SPLIT ON

Is the balance India strikes about right, or does it weigh family so heavily that individuals pay for it in the lives they end up living?

WHERE EACH SIDE STARTS

FOR THE MOTION

The weight sits too far on the family. People pay for it in careers, partners and cities they did not choose, and the culture should move.

AGAINST

The balance is not broken. Obligation is what makes families hold, and moving towards autonomy trades real security for individual preference.

YOUR CASE

Four or five points, one line each, in your own words. On stage you take them one at a time and elaborate, so write the trigger and not the speech.

1	
	BECAUSE
2	
	BECAUSE
3	
	BECAUSE
4	
	BECAUSE
5	
	BECAUSE

HOW TO DO THIS

BEFORE YOU SPEAK

Write your four or five strongest points on the front, one line each. Not a speech, just what will remind you of one.

ON STAGE

Take them one at a time and elaborate. A couple of minutes, so roughly thirty seconds a point.

IN THE REBUTTAL

Write down the claim the other side actually made, then answer that one, not the one you wish they had made.

THE ORDER

ROUND ONE

1 Speech, for

2 Speech, against

3 Rebuttals

4 Open floor

ROUND TWO

5 Speech, for

6 Speech, against

7 Rebuttals

8 Open floor

The room votes before the first speech and again after the last. Anyone may take an open floor, drawn or not.

WHILE THEY SPEAK

One row, one exchange. Their claim on the left, your answer on the right.

THEY SAID

MY ANSWER

ROUND ONE

1		
2		
3		

ROUND TWO

4		
5		
6		

THE ONE SENTENCE

The last thing you say is the thing the room votes on. Write it before you stand up.